Name	Hiew Jing Hong
Student ID	33351791
Studio Session	Friday 4pm

Part A: URL of the Visualisation

Paste your visualisation URL in the empty space below.
Tip: Test your URL in incognito mode to ensure it is a working URL

https://jhie0005-tech.github.io/FIT3179-A2/

Part B: Domain Description

Describe your domain chosen for DV II

My topic is Australian Art Collections.
To Investigate Australian artworks held in public collections. Compare collection themes, artistic periods, historic periods, or artwork categories to explore the development of Australian art.

I first found datasets online, then constructed a narrative from available data.

Describe the Why and Who aspects of your DV II

The target audience is the average Australian public, not an art expert or a gallery professional. They are curious about the art around them but have no specialist knowledge. The website tells a story about how public art moves from the national gallery network into city streets, and how materials, categories, locations and time periods differ between cities. The visualisations are explanatory (a guided narrative with a short "How to read it" note per map), not an exploratory analysis tool.

Because the site is a narrative, the high-level action is present (communicate a story), not discover. Within that, the main tasks are:

- Compare the three cities' categories, materials and time periods (the core of the story).
- Characterise distribution: where artworks cluster, such as dense city-centre areas versus sparse suburbs.
- Identify trends: how installation patterns change across early, middle and recent periods.
- Summarise overall patterns through aggregation (density, material groups).
- Lookup/identify individual artworks through tooltips, e.g. title and source category.

The main targets are spatial distributions, categorical comparison and temporal change.

Describe the "What" aspect of your DV II

The data are tables in which each row is a single artwork with a geographic position attached. The main dataset combines 961 public artworks from three cities (Brisbane 198, Melbourne 201, Canberra 562), and a second, smaller set of galleries drives the gallery locator and state maps. Each artwork has spatial attributes (latitude and longitude) that place it as a point, while context layers such as suburb boundaries, roads, and state and country outlines provide geographic reference. The categorical attributes are the city, a shared category that I built as a conservative crosswalk across the three councils' differing classification schemes, the original source category, and a material attribute that I grouped into Metal, Stone/concrete/brick, Timber, Paint, Tile/ceramic, Mixed materials, Other materials and Not recorded. The ordered attributes are the installation year and decade, which are quantitative and ordinal respectively. Binned counts are derived from the points for the density maps. The data also has quality limits that shape the design. Brisbane has no category field, so 186 of its 198 records are "Other / unclassified", which the site shows in muted grey and explains rather than hiding. Only 37 of the 562 Canberra records have dates, so the time-based views must disclose or exclude Canberra.

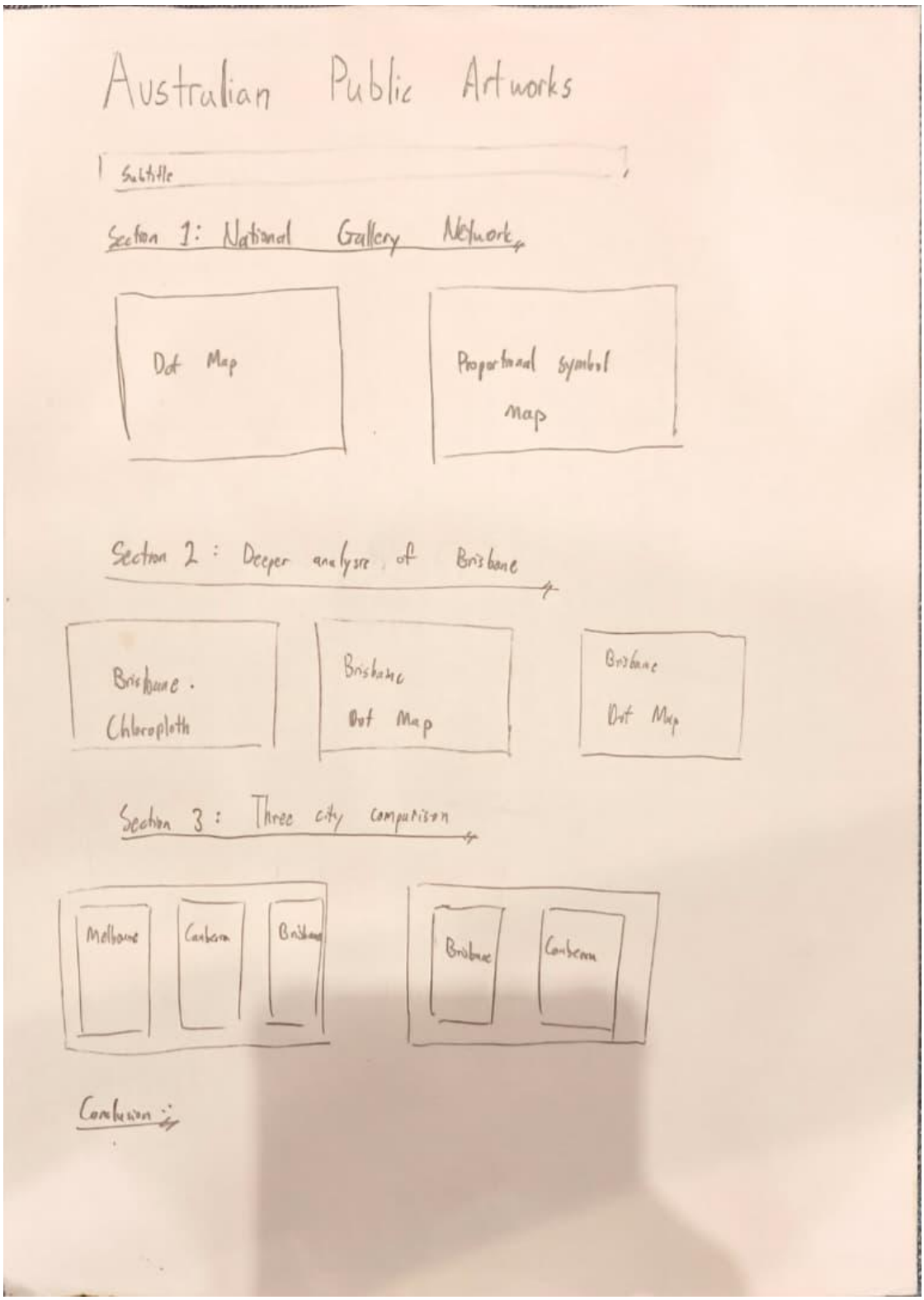
Describe the "How" aspect of your DV II

The visualisations encode each artwork as a point mark on a geographic map, using the position channel for latitude and longitude. Colour hue shows categorical attributes such as shared category and material group, with grey reserved for unclassified or unrecorded values so that missing data is not mistaken for a real category. Where points overlap too heavily to read, the density maps encode aggregated counts with a sequential colour scheme. They use a shared binned-count design, so the three cities can be compared on the same terms. To support comparison, the site uses small multiples, placing Brisbane, Melbourne and Canberra in separate framed panels, and it also compares Brisbane and Canberra side by side by material. It reduces the data in two ways: aggregation into density bins tackles overplotting in dense areas, and time slices (early, middle and recent) and decade filtering show a subset of the data at a time. Interaction is kept light because the audience is general. Tooltips give details on demand, such as an artwork's title and source category, and the planned interactive decade map would let users select a time range. Base layers of suburb boundaries, roads and outlines keep every map geographically readable. I chose points as the main mark because the items are discrete locations, and I add density only where overplotting hides the pattern.

Part C: Sketch

A URL to a PDF document with an image of your sketch on your GitHub account.
Tip: Test your URL in incognito mode to ensure it is a working URL

https://github.com/jhie0005-tech/FIT3179-A2/blob/main/DV2%20sketch.jpeg



Part D: Full-size screenshot of your DV II

Paste a full-size screenshot of your DV II assignment from the URL here

I exported the website to PDF and appended to the next page

AUSTRALIAN PUBLIC ART COLLECTIONS

From galleries to the street

Where is art held, and where does it become part of everyday city life? This story moves from Australia's gallery network to the public-art collections of Brisbane, Melbourne and Canberra.

PART 1 · NATIONAL CONTEXT

Public access begins with a gallery network

Before looking at art in streets and parks, the national gallery directory shows the institutions that make art available across Australia.

Galleries follow Australia's populated coasts

Mapped galleries cluster along the east and south-east coast, with smaller groups around the other capitals and regional centres. This is the institutional backdrop for the city collections that follow.

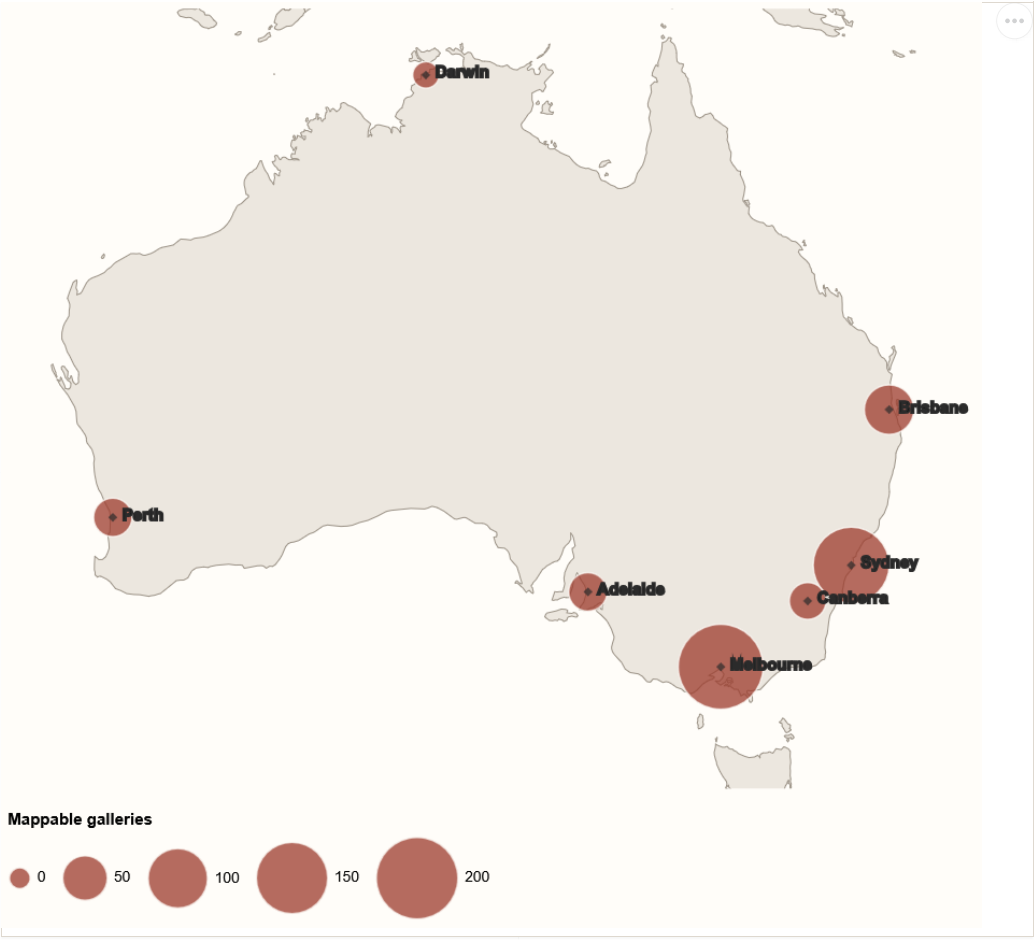
> **How to read it:** Each dot is one gallery with a usable location. Hover over a dot for the gallery name and address; dense groups show many nearby venues.



Gallery coverage is uneven by state

Aggregating the same directory makes the concentration clearer. The map compares the number of galleries with mappable coordinates, rather than the physical size of each state.

> **How to read it:** Larger circles mean more mappable galleries. Circles sit at capitals only to avoid overlap; they do not locate every gallery. Records without coordinates are excluded.



PART 2 · A CITY COLLECTION

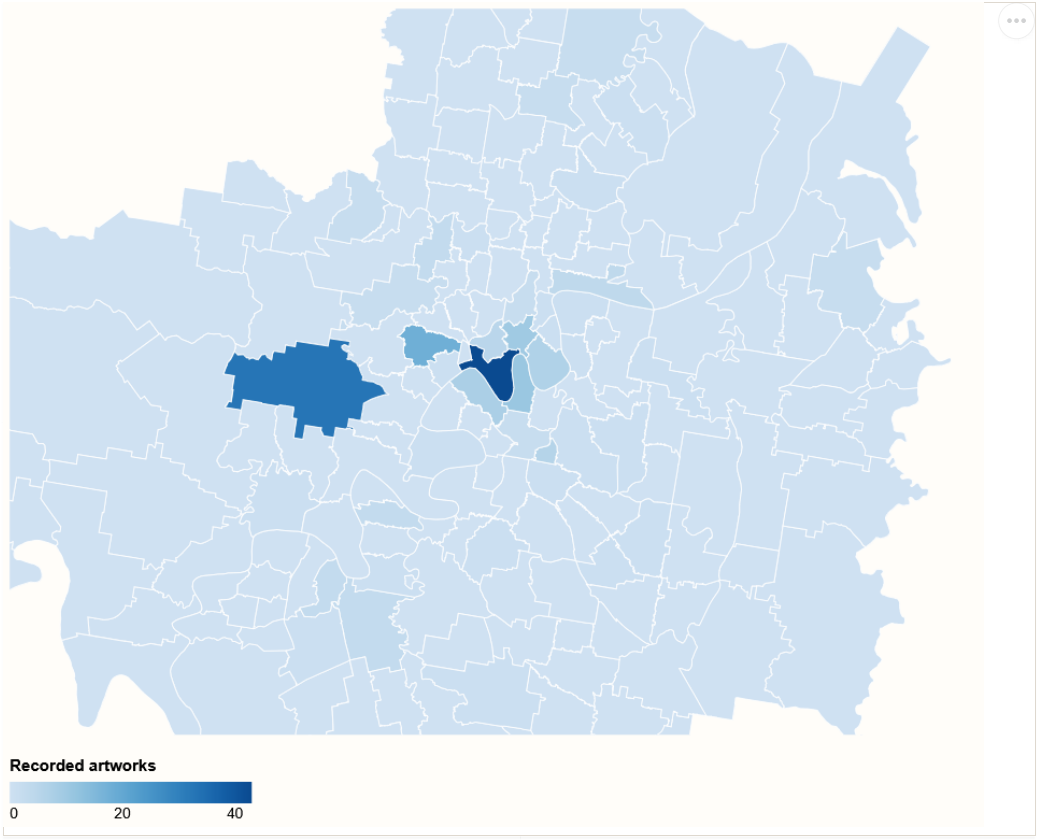
Brisbane shows how public art enters the urban landscape

The Brisbane collection lets us move from institutions to individual works: first their distribution, then their age and material.

A few suburbs hold most recorded works

Brisbane City and Mount Coot-tha have the largest recorded collections, followed by Paddington and Kangaroo Point. Elsewhere, works appear as smaller local groups.

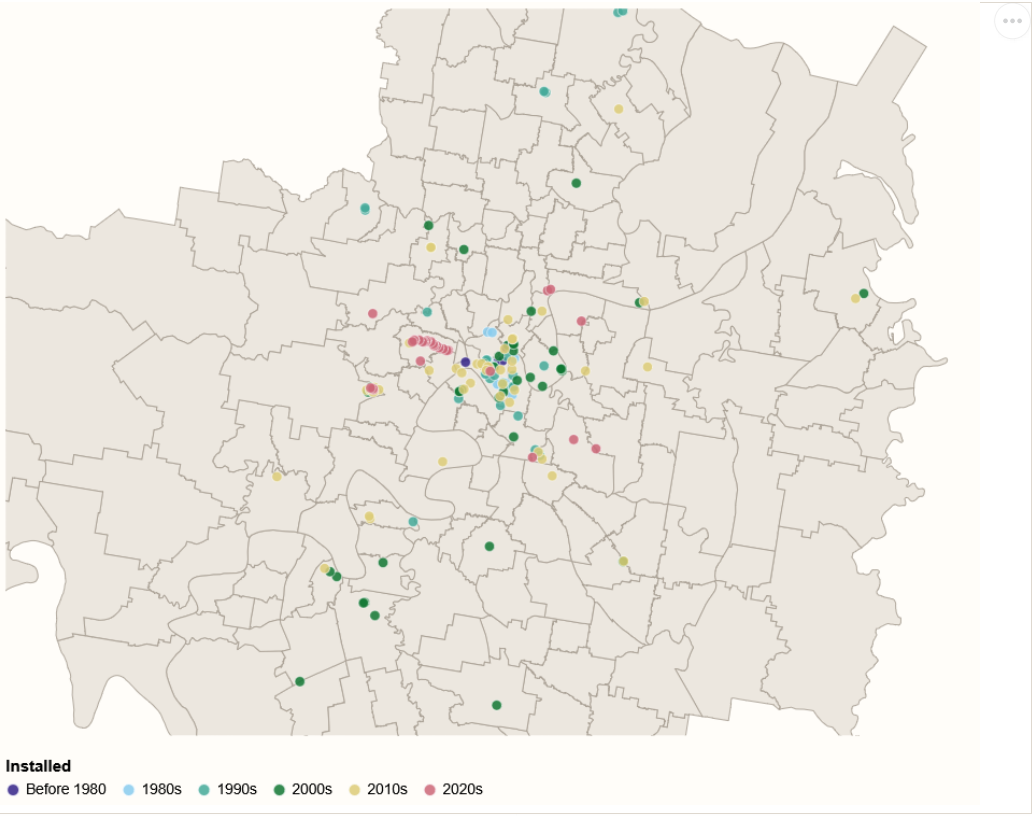
How to read it: Darker suburbs have more recorded artworks. Pale suburbs have no record in this dataset; this is not evidence that they contain no public art.



New commissions extend an older collection

Historic fountains and monuments sit alongside a larger wave of commissions from the 1990s onward. The collection has grown beyond the historic centre as later works appear across the city.

How to read it: Each dot is an artwork, coloured by its recorded installation period. Hover over a dot for its title, suburb, year and material.





Material gives Brisbane's collection its character

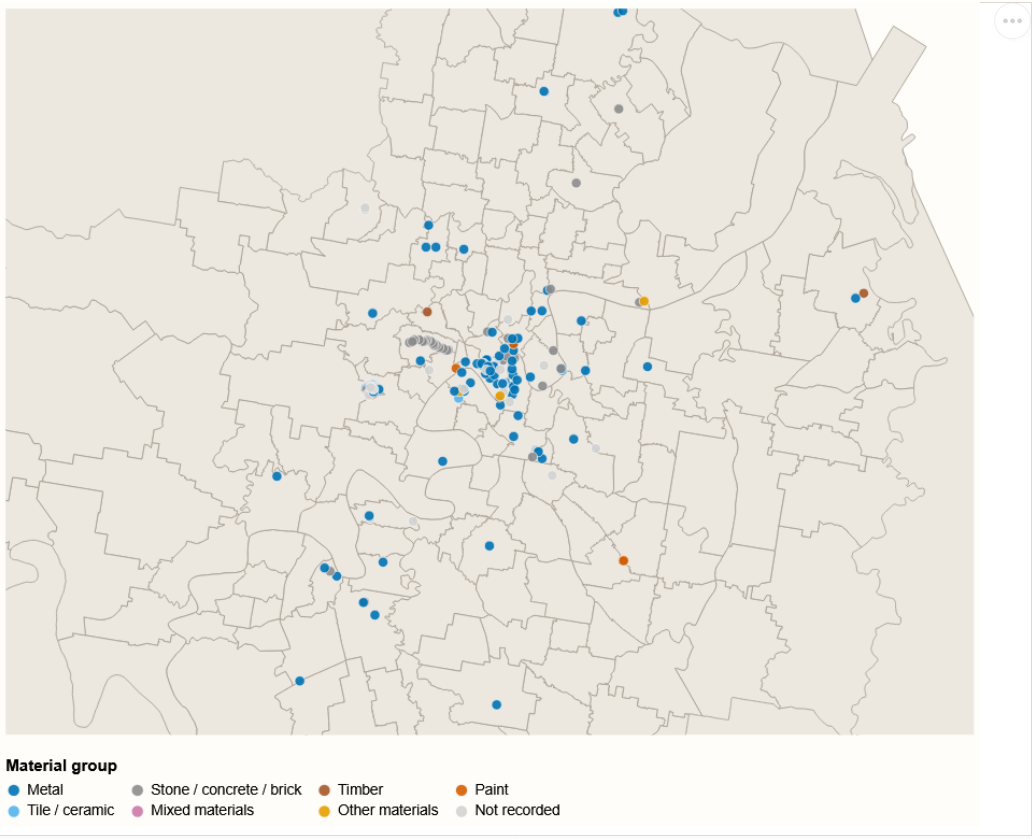
Brisbane records specific materials, revealing a collection dominated by bronze, steel, concrete and stone alongside smaller groups of ceramic, wood and light-based works.

> **How to read it:** Colour shows the main material group. Select a legend item to highlight it. Points at the same recorded location are gently separated so individual works remain visible.

Brisbane and Melbourne have different time profiles

Brisbane's recorded works concentrate in the 2000s. Melbourne has a larger pre-1980 group as well as substantial additions in the 1990s and 2000s.

> **How to read it:** Each bar counts artworks installed in that period. The two panels share a vertical scale. Canberra is omitted because most ACT records have no commissioning date; Melbourne entries without a single recorded year are excluded.



PART 3 · THREE CITY COLLECTIONS

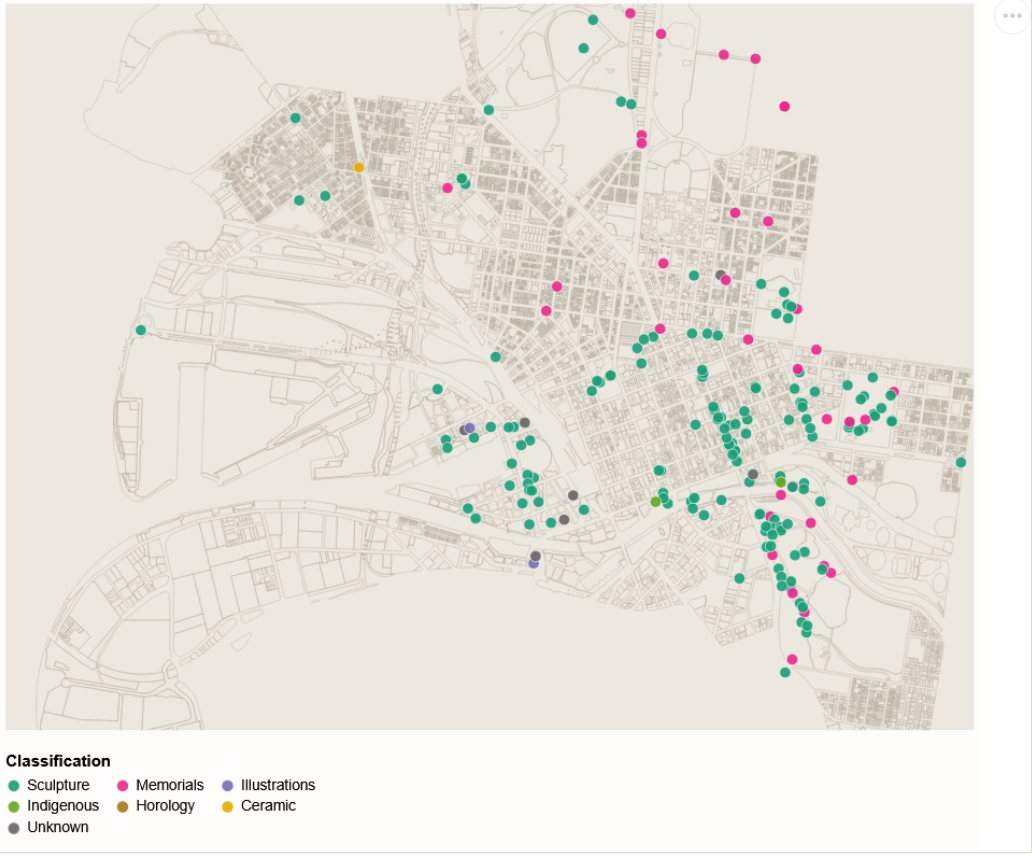
Different records reveal different kinds of public art

The three cities describe their collections differently. Reading their own labels first preserves that local detail; shared groups then make cautious comparisons possible.

Melbourne's records are led by sculpture

Melbourne classifies artworks rather than recording their material. Sculpture is the largest source category, while memorials, illustrations and other forms make up smaller groups.

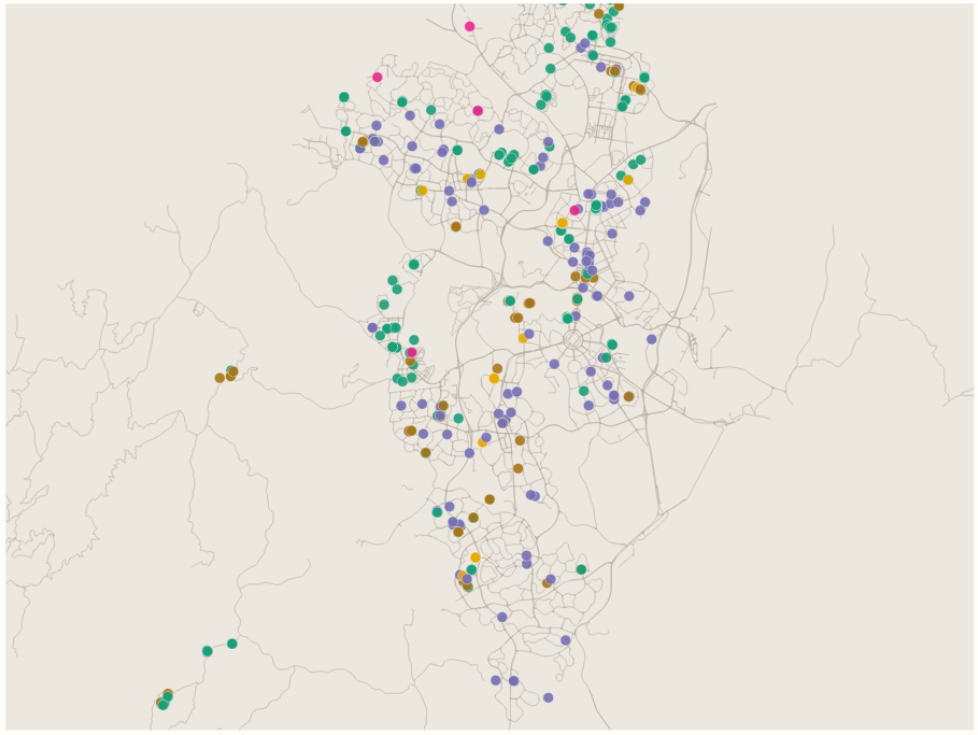
> **How to read it:** Each point is an artwork and property boundaries provide local context. Select a classification in the legend to focus on it. These source categories are not a direct material comparison with Brisbane.



Canberra mixes sculpture with civic features

ACT records are led by sculpture and features, with street art, murals and tiled works adding another visual language across Canberra's suburbs.

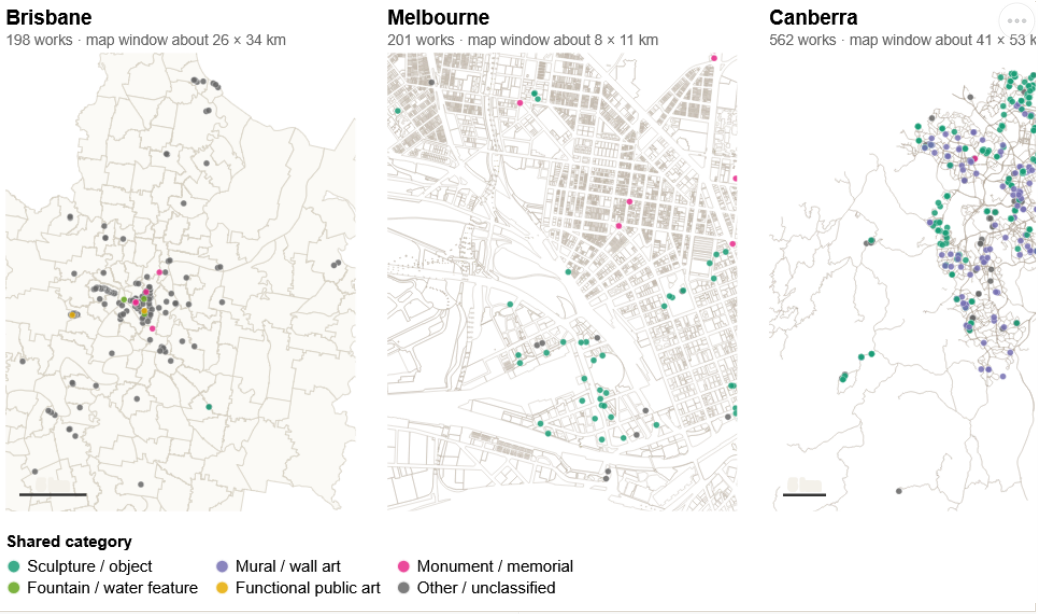
> **How to read it:** Each point is an ACT public-art record. Colour shows its source classification; select a legend item to bring that group forward. Hover for suburb, material, purpose and available commissioning detail.



A shared typology reveals different city patterns

To compare the cities, source labels were grouped into five broad types. Canberra spreads across a wide area, Melbourne gathers tightly around the centre, and Brisbane falls between those patterns.

> **How to read it:** Each panel has its own city extent, so check the scale bar before comparing distance. Hover for the shared group and original source label. Grey means unclassified, not unimportant; Brisbane records materials rather than artwork types, so most Brisbane works remain grey.

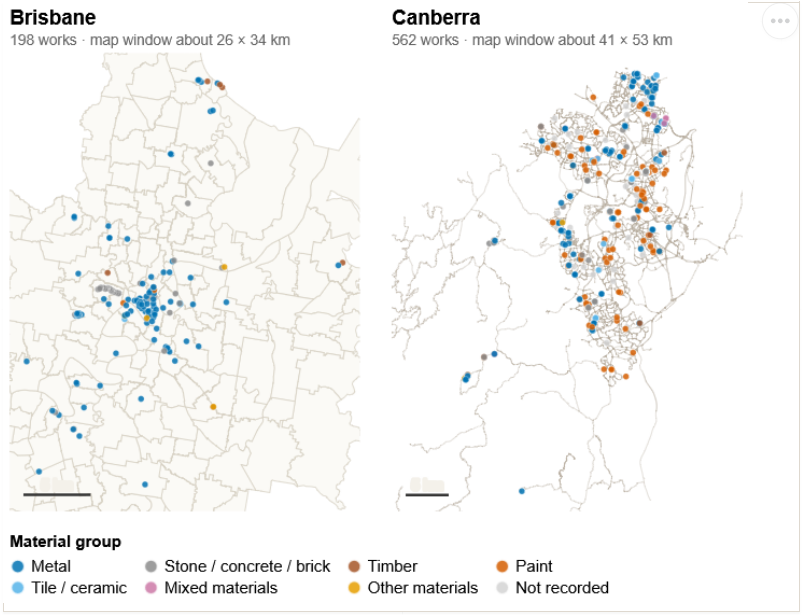


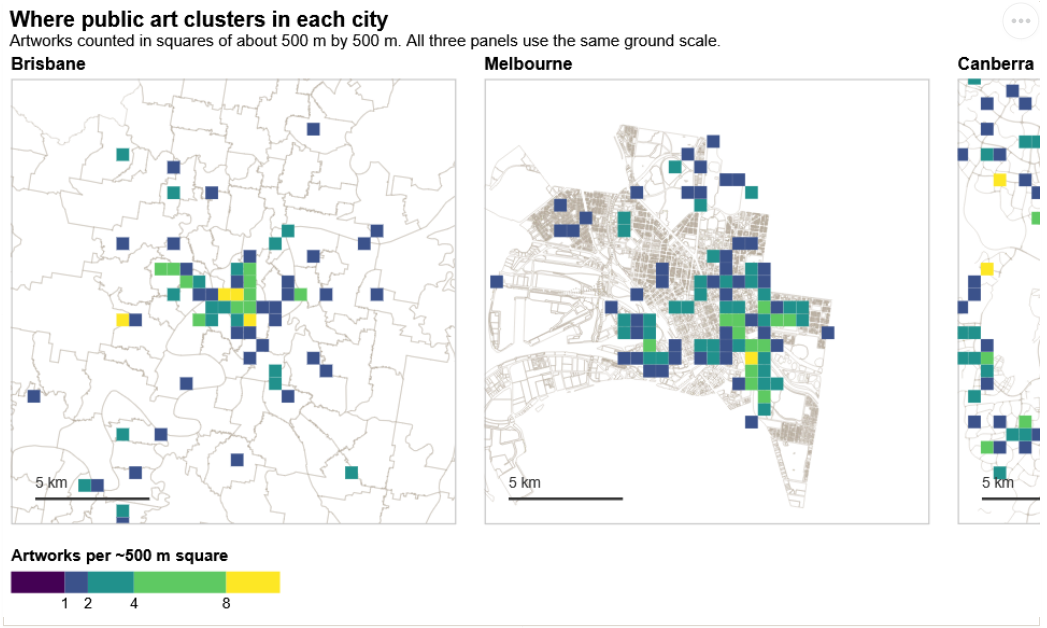
▸ How the shared groups were made

Material is comparable only for Brisbane and Canberra

Brisbane uses detailed material names, while Canberra's labels are broader and sometimes blank. Grouping them provides an approximate comparison: Canberra leans on paint and metal, while Brisbane is largely bronze, steel and stone.

> **How to read it:** Colour shows grouped materials, not artwork types. Melbourne is omitted because its records do not list materials. Canberra's broader labels make the groups approximate; grey means no material was recorded.





Public art clusters rather than spreading evenly

The final map combines the collection records into equal-sized squares. Across all three cities, a small number of precincts hold many works while large areas have few or none.

> **How to read it:** Each square covers about 500 m by 500 m. Darker squares contain more artworks, while blank areas contain none. Colours have the same meaning in every panel; check each scale bar before comparing distance.

CONCLUSION

Public art is shaped by place and by the way it is recorded

Gallery access is nationally concentrated, and city collections are concentrated too—but in different forms. Brisbane's material-rich records, Melbourne's classifications and Canberra's civic features each reveal a distinct relationship between art and public space.

Data and project details

Data sources

- Brisbane City Council, Public Art Collection.
- City of Melbourne, Public artworks, fountains and monuments.
- ACT Government / artsACT, ACT Public Art List.
- Art Guide Australia, Galleries directory; locations were geocoded for this project.

Method and limits

Maps use cleaned and locally processed extracts of the sources above. City records use different fields, coverage and collection practices, so cross-city comparisons are indicative rather than complete. Supplied suburb, property and road layers provide local geographic context.

Project information

Author: Jing Hong
Unit: FIT3179 Data Visualisation
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